

PART 9 WORLD CHAMPIONSHIPS

Rules amendments applying on **01.01.2026**

Chapter II PARTICIPATION IN THE UCI WORLD CHAMPIONSHIPS

§ 2 Selection of participants by specialty

Mountain bike

9.2.031 The categories for which the title of world champion will be awarded are as follows:

XCO	Men Elite (aged 23 and over); Men under 23 (ages from 19 to 22); Women Elite (aged 23 and over); Women under 23 (aged 19 to 22); Men Junior (aged 17 and 18); Women Junior (aged 17 and 18);
XCM	Men (aged 19 and over); Women (aged 19 and over);
XCR	Team (aged 17 and over);
XCC	Men (aged 23 and over); Women (aged 23 and over); Men under 23 (aged 19 to 22); Women under 23 (aged 19 to 22);
XCE	Men (aged 17 and over); Women (aged 17 and over);
DHI	Men Elite (aged 19 and over); Women Elite (aged 19 and over); Men Junior (aged 17 and 18); Women Junior (aged 17 and 18);
E-MTB	Men (aged 19 and over including Masters); Women (aged 19 and over including Masters)
PUM	Men (aged 17 and over); Women (aged 17 and over);
EDR	Men Elite (aged 19 and over); Women Elite (aged 19 and over); Men Junior (aged 17 and 18); Women Junior (aged 17 and 18);
E-EDR	Men Elite (aged 19 and over); Women Elite (aged 19 and over);
SNO	Men (aged 17 and over); Women (aged 17 and over)

*(article introduced on 01.01.04; text modified on 01.01.06; 01.02.12; 01.01.21; 01.01.23; 01.01.24; 01.01.25; **01.01.26**)*

9.2.034 For the Men Elite, Women Elite, Men Under 23 and Men Junior XCO events and the Men Elite and Men Junior DHI events, the maximum number of riders (apart from

reserves) for each **team nation** is determined on the basis of the classification by nation of the previous year's World Championships, as per the table below:

Nations ranked	Maximum number of riders (except reserves)
1 to 10 and the host nation	7
11 to 20	6
21 to 30	5
31 or after	4
Unranked nations	3

For the Women Under 23 and Women Junior XCO events, the Women Elite and Women Junior DHl events, the maximum number is 7 riders per nation.

Each federation shall be permitted to enter 2 reserves in each category.

For cross-country short track (XCC), each rider selected must already be registered for the cross-country Olympic (XCO) event. **The maximum number of riders for each nation is determined on the basis of the classification by nation of the previous year's World Championships, as per the table below:**

Nations ranked	Maximum number of riders (except reserves)
1 to 5 and the host nation	3
6 to 15	2
16 to end	1
Unranked nations	1

For cross-country eliminator (XCE), each national federation can enter unlimited number of riders per category.

For E-Mountain Bike **Cross-country** (E-MTB **XC**), the maximum number of riders shall be defined yearly.

For Enduro and E-Enduro (EDR/E-EDR), the maximum number of riders shall be defined yearly.

For Snow Bike (SNO), the maximum number of riders shall be defined yearly.

For Pump Track (PUM), the criteria for the number of riders as well as registration fees shall be defined yearly.

*(article introduced on 01.01.04; text modified on 01.01.06; 01.02.12; 01.01.16; 01.01.18; 01.01.21; 01.01.23; 01.01.25; **01.01.26**)*

9.2.038 The start order is determined as follows:
XCO Men Elite, XCO Women Elite, XCC Men Elite, and XCC Women Elite

1. as per the last published UCI XCO individual ranking;
2. place 33rd to 40th of the start order will be allocated to riders ranked in below rankings, unless they are listed on the start order between the place 1st to 32rd according to point 1 and 2 above:

- top 10 of the UCI cyclo-cross individual ranking;
- top 20 of the UCI road individual world ranking;

The place 33rd to 40th will be allocated following the rank of each rider, whatever the ranking: UCI cyclo-cross or UCI road world ranking. If two or three riders have the same ranking, they will be placed by drawing lots.

3. as per the last published UCI XCO individual ranking;
4. unclassified riders: by nations in rotation (*).

XCO Men under 23, XCO Women under 23, XCC Men under 23 and XCC Women under 23

1. as per the last published UCI XCO individual ranking;
2. unclassified riders: by nations in rotation (*).

XCO Men Junior, XCO Women Junior

3. as per the last published UCI XCO junior individual ranking;
4. Unclassified riders: by nations in rotation (*).

DHI Men Elite, DHI Women Elite

For the qualifying round and the final:

1. unclassified riders: by nations in rotation (*);
2. as per the last published UCI DHI individual ranking. The best rider starting last.

DHI Men Junior, DHI Women Junior

For the qualifying round and the final:

1. unclassified riders : by nations in rotation (*);
2. as per the last published UCI DHI individual ranking. The best rider starting last.

For all DHI events (Men Elite, Women Elite, Men Junior and Women Junior), riders are required to ride in the qualifying round. The number of riders qualifying for the final are as follows:

- Men Elite: top 80 riders in the qualifying round;
- Women Elite: top 40 riders in the qualifying round;
- Men Junior: top 60 riders in the qualifying round;
- Women Junior: top 20 riders in the qualifying round.

~~For the final in the Men Elite and Women Elite, the “protected riders” are:~~

- ~~— Riders ranked in the top 10 Women Elite and the top 20 Men Elite of the final world cup standings of the current season.~~

~~In case the UCI world cup final is held after the UCI World Championships, riders ranked in the top 10 Women Elite and the 20 Men Elite of the latest world cup standings of the current season.~~

~~Event “protected riders” must start in the qualifying round in order to be entitled to ride the final.~~

(*) The start order of the riders within the team must be confirmed by the national federations during the riders' confirmation. Taking each nation in turn on the basis of the classification by nation of the concerned category from the most recent mountain bike World Championships, a place is allocated to the next rider in sequence.

Unclassified nations take, on the basis of the same rotation system, the next places in an order determined by drawing lots.

E-MTB Men, E-MTB Women

The start order for E-MTB shall be defined yearly

Enduro/E-Enduro Men Elite, Enduro/E-Enduro Women Elite, ~~Enduro Men Junior, Enduro Women Junior~~

The start order for Enduro and E-Enduro shall be defined yearly.

Snow Bike Men, Snow Bike Women

The start order for Snow Bike shall be defined yearly.

(article introduced on 01.01.04; text modified on 01.01.06; 25.09.08; 01.01.11; 01.05.11; 01.01.18; 01.01.12; 01.01.23; 01.01.24; 01.01.26)

Competition format

9.2.059 In all categories, the Trials world championships shall include a ½ Finals and a Final round.

½ Finals

The Trials world championships will commence with a ½ Finals round. The world championships ½ Finals round is open to all riders entered. The ½ Finals round shall consist of three laps of five sections. The commissaires' panel will set the competition time according to the number of entered riders.

Final round

The riders eligible to compete in the Final rounds shall be as follows:

- if the category has 6 riders or less, the best 3 riders in the ½ Final round will be eligible to compete in the Final;
- if the category has between 7 and 8 riders, the best 4 riders in the ½ Final round will be eligible to compete in the Final;
- if the category has 9 riders or more, the best 6 riders in the ½ Final round will be eligible to compete in the Final.

The scores gained in the ½ Finals round do not count in the Final round.

Final procedure

At the Final round, ~~it will be applied the six by six system: the number of riders eligible to compete will be determined as per above rules and then adjusted accordingly:~~ Before the start, the ~~six~~ riders will be presented on the ~~stage start podium~~, in inverse order to the position obtained in the ½ Finals round. After the presentation, they must go to section one. The order to start will be determined by the result obtained in the ½ Finals round. Riders that obtained the ~~lowest ranked sixth place~~ shall start first in section one and so on. The same principle applies for the remaining sections. Once a rider finishes a section, the next rider has maximum thirty seconds to start the section. After this thirty second the sections time is running. In case of slight injury,

the other rider must overtake and start the section in front of him/her. In case of tie, article 7.1.047 of the UCI Trials Regulations shall apply. Competitors taking part in the Final must have two bicycles at their disposal. The spare second bicycle shall remain in the rider's area for the duration of the competition and may be retrieved as a replacement for the first bicycle. ~~A rider qualified for the Final who chooses not to compete in the Final shall get seventh placed in the Final classification and shall (in the Final) be replaced by the seventh placed rider in the ½ Finals. Two qualified riders choosing not to compete in the Final shall get seventh and eighth placed in the final classification and shall be replaced by the seventh and eighth placed riders in the ½ Finals (in the Finals), etc. Two qualified riders choosing not to compete in the Final shall get seventh and eighth placed in the final classification and shall be replaced by the seventh and eighth placed riders in the ½ Finals (in the Finals), etc.~~

A rider qualified for the Final who chooses not to compete in the Final shall be placed in the classification being the first place in the ½ Final classification, he/she shall be replaced by the rider ranked following him/her in the classification.

The same principle shall be applied if more riders decide not to compete in the Final.

(text modified on 01.02.11; 13.03.15; 30.01.17; 01.01.25; 01.01.26)

Para Cycling (participation)

9.2.062 National Federations register their riders through the same online registration system no later than ~~three~~ four weeks before the first race of the World Championships. At the time of registration, up to six substitutes can be added to the team for all classes combined. The registration shall give details of the number of persons making up each delegation, the riders registered for each race as well as their sport class, the accommodation used during the World Championships, full contact details of the team manager and each athlete's time of arrival.

After the registration deadline (~~3~~ four weeks before the World Championships), late registrations will be invoiced CHF 200.- per athlete.

Starters must be confirmed in each sport class at the official confirmation time as announced in the technical programme of the ~~event~~ competition.

Last-minute changes of registered athletes can only be achieved by means of a medical certificate 24 hours before the start of the race.

(text modified on 03.02.17; 01.07.18; 01.01.26)

9.2.065 At World Championships, in each of the Para Cycling events, the outgoing world champion will be given an additional slot for the event in which he was a world champion. If the outgoing world champion cannot participate at the World Championships, this place is not accumulated in the quota of the nation.

~~One (1) additional slot for individual time trial, pursuit and 500m / 1000m will be awarded to nations which have reached the maximum number of participants and wishing to enter an athlete under 16 years of age.~~

(article introduced on 01.10.13; text modified on 01.01.19; 01.01.26)

Athletes' eligibility

- 9.2.067** Except the reigning world champion, athletes participating in the UCI Para Cycling World Championships must have participated in at least one UCI Para Cycling event on the UCI International Calendar (National Championships, Class 2, Class 1, World Cup, ~~or~~ Continental Championships, Regional Games, World Championships or Paralympic Games) during the last 12 months, but no later than 30 days before the event, defined as the Qualification Period.

(article introduced on 01.10.13; text modified on 20.12.17; 01.07.20; 01.01.26)

Earning slots for the World Championships Para Cycling Track

- 9.2.068** ~~A nation that has earned UCI track points at a C1, C2 or Continental Championships event during the Qualification Period in a specific sport class has the right to enter an athlete in that sport class in the upcoming UCI Para-cycling Track World Championships.~~

~~A nation earns 1 slot in a specific Sport Class if any of its athlete has earned UCI Para Cycling Track Individual Ranking points during the Qualification Period in the respective Sport Class.~~

(article introduced on 01.10.13; text modified on 01.01.19; 01.07.20; 01.01.26)

- 9.2.069** ~~A nation may enter two athletes in a sport class in which an athlete earned track C1 or track Continental Championships points in that sport class during the Qualification Period. One of the two registered athletes must have earned points in one of the abovementioned events.~~

~~A nation earns 2 slots in a specific Sport Class if any athlete has earned UCI Para Cycling Track Individual Ranking points during the Qualification Period in the respective Sport Class. At least one athlete must be in the top 20 of the UCI Para Cycling Track Individual Ranking.~~

(article introduced on 01.10.13; text modified on 01.01.19; 01.07.20; 01.01.26)

- 9.2.069
bis** ~~A nation may enter three athletes in a sport class in which two athletes have earned track C1 or track Continental Championships points in that sport class, including at least one athlete in the top 10 and first half of the UCI Para-cycling track ranking during the Qualification Period. Two of the three athletes must have C1 points.~~

~~A nation earns 3 slots in a specific Sport Class if at minimum 2 athletes have earned UCI Para Cycling Track Individual Ranking points during the Qualification Period in the respective Sport Class. At least one athlete must be in the top 20 of the UCI Para Cycling Track Individual Ranking.~~

(article introduced on 01.07.20; text modified on 01.01.26)

- 9.2.069
ter** The number of slots obtained by a nation is valid for Time Trial, Individual Pursuit, Scratch race, Elimination, Tandem Sprint and Sprint.

~~A nation that has earned a slot in a specific Sport Class is eligible to enter any athlete who meets the eligibility criteria mentioned in article 9.2.067 in that Sport Class at the upcoming UCI Para Cycling Track World Championships.~~

The slots will be awarded based on the UCI Para Cycling Track Individual Ranking closing seven (7) weeks before the competition (including Classification) starts.

(article introduced on 01.07.20; text modified on 01.01.26)

Para Cycling Road

- 9.2.070** A nation that has earned UCI **Para Cycling Road** points at a **Class 1**, **Class 2**, or Continental Championships event during the Qualification Period in a specific sport class has the right to enter an athlete in that Sport Class in the upcoming UCI Para-cycling Road World Championships.

(article introduced on 01.10.13; text modified on 01.01.16; 01.07.20; 08.02.21; 01.01.26)

- 9.2.071 bis** A nation may enter three athletes in a Sport Class in which two athletes have earned **Para Cycling Road** World Cup points in that Sport Class and at least 1 athlete has finished in the top 10 **at a UCI Para Cycling Road World Cup race** during the Qualification Period. Two of the three athletes entered must have **Para Cycling Road** World Cup points during the Qualification Period.

(article introduced on 01.07.20; text modified on 08.02.21; 01.01.26)

- 9.2.071 ter** The number of slots obtained by a nation is valid for Time Trial and Road Race.

A nation that has earned a slot in a specific Sport Class is eligible to enter any athlete who meets the eligibility criteria mentioned in article 9.2.067 in that Sport Class at the upcoming UCI Para Cycling Road World Championships.

(article introduced on 01.07.20; text modified on 01.01.26)